

output and support for plugins. For audio editing, look no further than Audacity since it offers several features similar to Audition Pro. Many other tools are included in the Adobe Creative Suite, and due to its sheer potential, we went out and wrote an FT on open source alternative tools for creative editing suites in July 2015. Rather than paying ₹32,400 for a year of all the Adobe Creative Suite tools, you could use these free ones instead. A comprehensive coverage has been done and you'll find more tools in this category.

Music Streaming Services

Listening to music is a healthy habit and in fact, listening to certain genres of music while working increases your productivity. Contrary to the good old' days of buying Music CDs, the current age is rocking through a number of music streaming services. There are several to choose from and Spotify (not available in India), Apple Music, Gaana, Saavn are the ones that would pop in your mind. Although most of the services work with a subscription plan that gives you a seamless experience with better features, you would still have to pay for them. Partially free services such as Gaana, Saavn and Wynk let you play songs by serving you with ads but people usually overlook the best and obvious source for music – YouTube. Every major artist and band out there, even Indie artists share their music or lyric videos on YouTube, making it the best source for music. The only caveat here is the platform. While you can play songs on your desktop endlessly, the YouTube app doesn't support

background playback (a feature on its way soon) so you can't play the videos if you close or minimise the app. Hence sadly, when it comes to listening to music from your mobile, you won't get features like offline playback but at the expense of your internet data, you'll still be able to stream music for free on the music streaming services mentioned above.

Video Games

When it comes to playing video games, not everyone actually buys them. But that's not what you should be doing. Video games can be expensive, agreed, but there are so many other games available for free that you might end up spending more time playing them. Digital distribution platforms such as Steam, Origin, Desura etc., have several free to play games. For the ones who are unaware, yes, there are games that won't ask you to pay apart from the

Humble Bundle

Catch great deals and bundles on video games every week

additional micro transactions in-game which aren't mandatory. Popular games such as Team Fortress 2, Dota 2, World of Tanks, Star Wars: The Old Republic etc., can be downloaded and played for free. Websites such as IndieDB and Gamejolt list out games developed by independent developers, and most of them are available as demo or full version. Now you might be wondering how you could get your hands on the games from major studios and publishers, and the best way is to wait for online sales. Another method of acquiring games for cheap would be to sign up for game bundles such as Humble Bundle, Indiegala, BundleStars, One More Bundle etc. Rarely, you will find these bundles packing triple A games at surprisingly cheap prices.

Miscellaneous applications

When it comes to security, free antivirus services like Avast and free firewall tools like ZoneAlarm are quite robust. In case of malware and adware infection, you can trust Malwarebytes and AdwCleaner. For developers, an endless number of free and open-source IDEs are available, most



Comprehensive coverage of alternatives

of them vouching for Eclipse and Visual Studio Community edition (free version of the Visual Studio Suite). Cloud Storage services are abundant and since they are free, there's no harm in checking them all out. Picking one out of either Google Drive or OneDrive is a choice you need to make based on the ecosystem you're more accustomed with using. It's clear that the software category is vast and many other categories need to be covered. So vast, that we had to dedicate an entire FT where we made an extensive coverage of even the most obscure categories on the internet. Make sure you check out December 2015's FT to Free PC Software. We are quite confident that after completing this FT, all your software woes for PC will find closure.

So there you have it. There's no debate whether premium gadgets and software aren't good enough but the debate here is whether you need them, especially under a tight budget. Turns out that it is sustainable to be completely dependent on inexpensive gadgets and free/open source software. The only bottleneck you'll face is during advanced requirements of features and support, otherwise you can face the world and the internet by depending on these alternatives.

Armed with this cheatsheet, you finally move towards the final step of being a Kanjoos. Until then, spend well my friend. 



YouTube is a great music streaming service